The Step 16 Failure

Why two calls stopped halfway on 5 November, and what was done about it

On 5 November two seller calls went halfway through the system and stopped. Steps 1 to 15 ran. Steps 17 to 27 did not. Nobody was told, and nothing on a phone or in a chat room looked wrong.

The cause was step 16: a POST to another Zap, which answered **"please unsubscribe me!"**. Zapier stops a run at the first step that errors, so everything after step 16 was skipped.

What "please unsubscribe me!" means

It is not a server being down or a network problem. It is the exact reply Zapier's own catch hooks give when the Zap behind them is not live. The receiving end is telling the sender to stop calling: there is nobody here.

> **Which makes the diagnosis a lookup, not a hunt**
>
> That one phrase says the target Zap exists and is switched off. It rules out a bad URL, a timeout, a credential, and a rate limit in one line -- which is why this took twenty minutes to settle once anybody actually read the error.

Following it to the end

Step 16 posts to hook 4hgbqo2
Sending call_id, section5, section5_detail, dnc and call_type -- the compliance fields off the call analysis.

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4hgbqo2 answers "please unsubscribe me!"
So that hook belongs to a Zap that is not running.

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The Zap it belongs to is "(Copy) Retell Monday AI"
Switched off, and marked Draft -- never published, not switched off later. Someone duplicated a Zap to edit it and stopped partway.

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The live original is "Retell Monday AI", hook 4hmkrz1
A different hook. Nothing in the call pipeline posts to it.

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That live Zap has run zero times in 30 days
So it is not quietly doing the job instead. Nothing has been feeding it either.

Which settles what step 16 was for, and what to do about it: it pointed at a copy somebody abandoned mid-edit. It has almost certainly **never** succeeded -- this was not a working step that broke on 5 November.

Three options, and why it was the second

Option	Verdict
A. Turn the target Zap on	No. It is an unfinished draft. Publishing half-edited work into a live call pipeline trades one fault for a worse one.
B. Remove step 16	Yes. It has never delivered anything, so nothing that was working is lost -- and calls stop dying.
C. Repoint it at the live Zap	Not yet. The live Zap writes to a monday.com board that has received nothing for a month. Wiring a call pipeline to a board nobody reads is work, not a fix.

Step 16 was deleted and the Zap published. If anyone turns out to use that monday.com board, a replacement step can be added later pointing at **4hmkrz1** -- with its error handling set so it can never halt a call again.

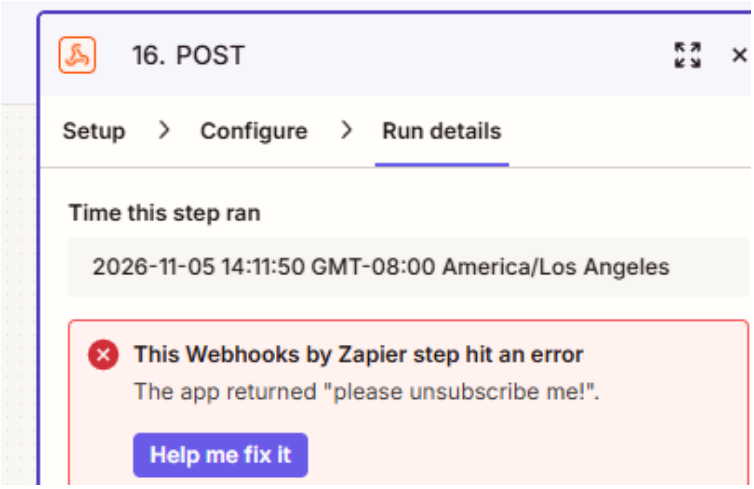
> **The part worth remembering**
>
> A step whose only job is to notify something else was able to stop sellers' calls being processed. That is the real defect, and it is not specific to step 16: any new POST added to this Zap can do the same thing. Anything non-essential in the middle of a call pipeline needs to be unable to halt it.

What it cost

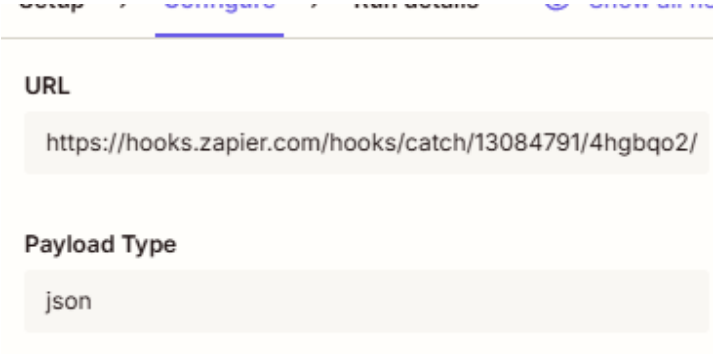
- **Two calls on 5 November** lost steps 17 to 27 entirely.
- **Every call before that** hit the same error. The run halted each time; only the two on the 5th were traced.
- **Zapier tasks.** A failed step still counts. With the account moving to the 2,000-task plan, a step that fails on every call is allowance spent on nothing.
- **A month of noise.** Zap history carried a red error on every run, which is how a history page stops being read.

The proof

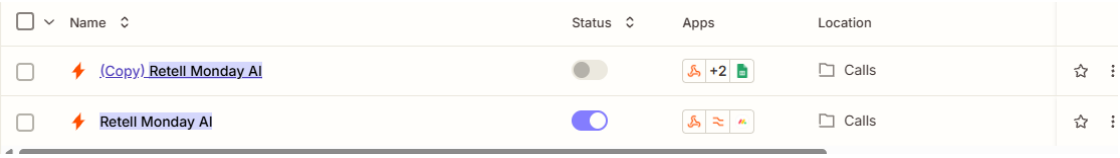
In the order the checks were made, on 7 November 2026.



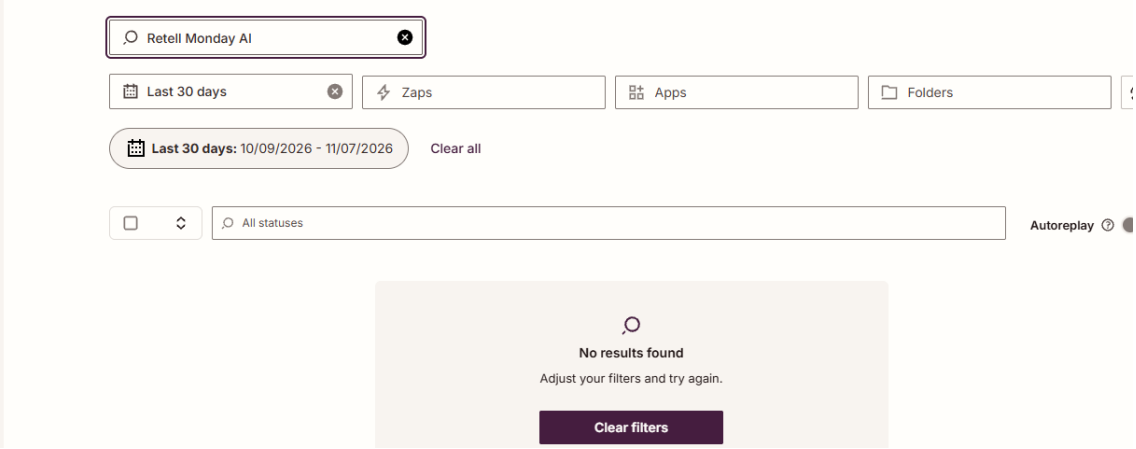
1. The failure. Step 16, 5 November 14:11:50 Pacific. "The app returned 'please unsubscribe me!'" -- the reply a Zapier catch hook gives when its Zap is not live.



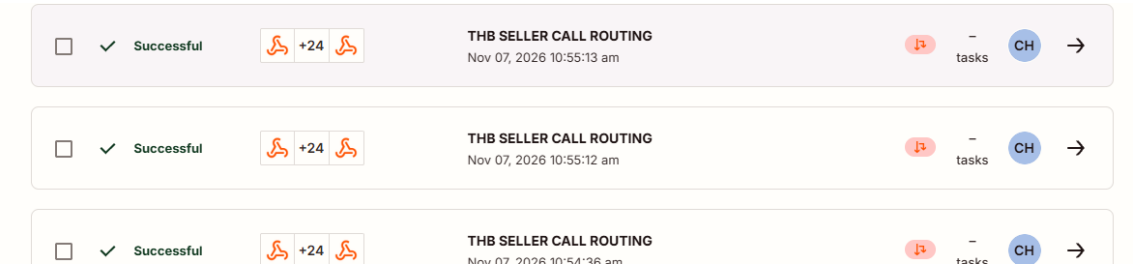
2. Where it was posting. Hook **4hgbqo2**, carrying the compliance fields: section5, section5 detail, dnc, call type.



3. Who owns that hook. "(Copy) Retell Monday AI" -- toggle off. Opening it showed **Draft**: never published. The live "Retell Monday AI" below it is on, and answers a different hook, 4hmkrz1.



4. The live Zap is not doing it instead. Zero runs in 30 days. Nothing feeds 4hmkrz1 either, so no monday.com item or Sheets row has been created in at least a month.



5. After the fix. Three consecutive runs of THB SELLER CALL ROUTING, all Successful, each through 24+ steps. Before, every run stopped at 16.